

MANIFEST: Part 7– June 7th



I. Welcome!

If you are a first-time guest or you want to plug in more to weekly virtual prayer meetings, our Wednesday night small groups, serving, or membership—*Fill out our digital Connect card to stay connected!*



II. Announcements:



Summer Cookout: Join us at the Stevens' Home on June 6th at 4pm for a GateCity Buckhead Summer Cookout! This will be an evening full of good food, great community, and fresh vision for GCB for the summer & fall. Scan the QR code to sign up

Check out our weekly GCB email for more exciting events this week and this summer!

III. Grant us Boldness, Hazen Stevens

Key Texts: Luke 24:49 · Acts 1:8 · Acts 4:29–31

Big Idea: The Spirit clothes ordinary people with boldness, and He works through two hands at once: our willingness to speak, and His power to open hearts.

I. Pray Before You Go

Luke 24:49

"Wait... until you are clothed with power from on high."

- Greek *endyō* = to put on like a garment.
- Boldness is worn, not manufactured.

II. The Promise and the Witness

Acts 1:8

"You will receive power... you will be witnesses."

- Greek *martys* = witness (root of *martyr*).
- A whole life that testifies, sometimes at cost.

III. The Prayer That Shook the Room

Acts 4:29–31

"Grant Your servants to speak Your word with all boldness."

- They did not pray for the threats to stop; they prayed for boldness.
- Greek *parrēsia* = "all-speech," holding nothing back.
- Total openness, not polish.
- Division of labor:
 - **We speak.**
 - **God stretches out His hand to heal.**

IV. The Two Hands of Boldness

Mark 16:20

"They preached... the Lord working with them."

- Natural + supernatural, every time.
- Our willingness to speak.

His power to confirm and open hearts.

Four Snapshots of the Spirit at Work

-Philip & the Ethiopian (Acts 8:29, 39): A whisper, a question, and one act of obedience helped carry the gospel to a nation.

-Lydia (Acts 16:14): "The Lord opened her heart." We cannot open hearts; God does.

-The Macedonian Call (Acts 16:6–10): Closed doors led to God's redirection, carrying the gospel into Europe.

Peter & Cornelius (Acts 10:19–20, 44): Peter obeyed, preached, and the Spirit opened the door -to the Gentiles.

Bring It Home: Most of It Is Ordinary

The spectacular is real, but most boldness is practical.

The question.

The conversation.

Going a little out of your way.

- Some resist, some respond.
- Persevere, because the one open-hearted moment is coming.

The Challenge

- Go out of your way.
- Be open about your own struggles.
- Ask questions.
- Be honest about your pain.
- *Parrēsia*: nothing held back.
- You will create more ministry opportunities than you have time for.
- The Spirit does the rest.

Notes: